

# Dr. Christian König

*Curriculum vitae*

*June 2026*

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Postdoctoral researcher at the WZB Berlin Social Science Center, Reichpietschufer 50, 10785 Berlin.  
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## Current Position

01/2024– *Postdoctoral Researcher* in the Research Unit on Skill Formation and Labor Markets (head: Heike Solga), WZB Berlin Social Science Center

## Research Interests

Socio-spatial inequalities  
Environmental and Climate Sociology  
Urban Sociology  
Education & Labor Markets  
Quantitative Methods & Causal Inference

## Previous Positions

2019–2023 *Doctoral Researcher* in the Research Group on Health and Social Inequality (head: Jan Paul Heisig), WZB Berlin Social Science Center

2019–2021 *Research Assistant* at the Cluster of Excellence "The Politics of Inequality" (supervisors: Guido Schwerdt, Stephan Maurer), University of Konstanz

2018 *Graduate Trainee* in the Directorate General for Innovation and Technology, European Parliament

## Education

- 2024 PhD in Sociology (*summa cum laude*), Free University Berlin  
*Dissertation title: "(Un)healthy Places: Causes, Patterns, and Consequences of Environmental Inequality in Urban Germany"*  
Commission: Jan Paul Heisig (supervisor, reviewer), Rourke O'Brien (reviewer), Heike Solga, Martin Ehlert, Alessandro Ferrara
- 2019 M.Sc., Economics, University of Konstanz  
*Thesis Title: "Do Voluntary Environmental Information Programs Affect Individual Transportation Choice?"* (Supervisor: Stephan Maurer)
- 2016 B.A., Political Science and Economics, Eberhard Karls University Tübingen  
*Thesis Title: "Stakeholders and Opportunities in German Fiscal Policy"* (Supervisor: Daniel Buhr)

## Research Stays Abroad

- 2021 *Visiting PhD Researcher*, Department of Sociology, University of Copenhagen
- 2017 *Visiting Graduate Student*, Department of Economics and Department of Environmental and Resource Economics, University of Massachusetts Amherst

## Administrative tasks

### *Committee Work*

- 2020– Department representative at the Academic Council, WZB Berlin Social Science Center
- 2026 Dahrendorf Fellowship selection committee, WZB Berlin Social Science Center
- 2025 Seed money funding selection committee, WZB Berlin Social Science Center
- 2020 Flexible funding selection committee, WZB Berlin Social Science Center

### *Organisation*

- 2021 Organisation of Workshop on "Spatial analysis of social, environmental, and health inequalities", WZB Berlin Social Science Center
- 2020 Organisation of EAERE 2020 conference session (panel session on "Transportation and Environment")

## **Referee Work**

*Environmental Sociology, European Sociological Review, Journal of Ethnic and Migration Studies, Research in Social Stratification and Mobility, Social Forces, Social Science Research, Urban Studies*

## **Memberships**

ISA Research Committee 28 on "Social Stratification and Mobility", European Consortium for Sociological Research (ECSR)

## **Funds**

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|------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2021 | WZB Berlin Social Science Center seed money for an online survey experiment (10.500 EUR) |
| 2019 | WZB Berlin Social Science Center funds for data purchase (20.000 EUR)                    |

## **Awards and Scholarships**

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|------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2026 | Peter A. Berger Dissertation Award (German Sociological Association, DGS) |
| 2021 | WZB World Merit Fellowship (6.200 EUR)                                    |
| 2017 | Deutscher Akademischer Auslandsdienst (DAAD), PROMOS (2.800 EUR)          |

## **Research**

### **Publications**

- Nennstiel, R. and König, C. (2026) 'The thermostat of opportunity: Home air conditioning, its social gradient, and educational consequences', *Energy Research & Social Science*. Available (Open Access): <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.erss.2026.104785>
- König, C., Salomo, K., Helbig, M. (2026) 'Understanding Variation in Neighborhood Environmental Inequalities: The Influence of Residential Segregation, Gentrification, and other City-Level Factors', *Urban Studies*. Available (Open Access): <https://doi.org/10.1177/00420980251412793>
- König, C. (2024) 'Neighborhood structure and environmental quality: A fine-grained analysis of spatial inequalities in urban Germany', *Urban Studies*. Available (Open Access): <https://journals.sagepub.com/doi/10.1177/00420980231224224>.
- König, C., Heisig, J. P. (2023). Environmental Inequality and Health Outcomes over the Life Course. In R. Hoffmann (Ed.), *Handbook of Health Inequalities Across the Life Course*. Edward Elgar Publishing.
- Heisig, J.P., König, C. and Solga, H. (2022a) 'Arbeit und Beschäftigung', in *Abschlussbericht Repräsentativbefragung zur Teilhabe von Menschen mit Behinderungen*. Bonn: Bundesministerium für Arbeit und Soziales.

- Heisig, J.P., König, C. and Solga, H. (2022b) 'Bildung', in *Abschlussbericht Repräsentativbefragung zur Teilhabe von Menschen mit Behinderungen*. Bonn: Bundesministerium für Arbeit und Soziales.
- Heisig, J.P., König, C. and Solga, H. (2022c) 'Ökonomische Situation und materielle Sicherheit', in *Abschlussbericht Repräsentativbefragung zur Teilhabe von Menschen mit Behinderungen*. Bonn: Bundesministerium für Arbeit und Soziales.
- Heisig J. P., König C. (2021) Dicke Luft - Arme Haushalte und Menschen ohne deutschen Pass leben häufiger in Gegenden mit hoher Umweltbelastung. *WZB Mitteilungen*, Heft 173, September 2021: 16-19
- Heisig J.P., König C., Löbl S. (2021) Ängste, Sorgen und psychische Gesundheit in der Corona-Pandemie. In: Badura B., Ducki A., Schröder H., Meyer M. (eds) *Fehlzeiten-Report 2021*. Fehlzeiten-Report, vol 2021. Springer, Berlin, Heidelberg. Available at: [https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-662-63722-7\\_8](https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-662-63722-7_8)
- Heisig, J. P. and König, C. (2020). Das Virus ist nicht demokratisch - Soziale Ungleichheit prägt den Verlauf der Infektion. *WZB Mitteilungen*, Heft 168, Juni 2020: 39-41.
- Heisig, J. P. and König, C. (2020). Wie und warum die gesundheitlichen Folgen vom sozialen Status abhängen. *Corona und die gesellschaftlichen Folgen - Schlaglichter aus der WZB-Forschung*.

## Work in Progress

Cross-national analysis of the short- and longer-term effects of conditions at labor market entry (*with Thomas Biegert, Jan Paul Heisig, and Heike Solga*)

Working paper available at: <https://doi.org/10.5281/ZENODO.15349521>

Explorative analysis of the short- and longer-term effects of economic conditions at labor market entry on leaving the parental home and family formation (*with Thomas Biegert, Jan Paul Heisig, and Heike Solga*)

Working paper available at: <https://doi.org/10.5281/ZENODO.15585190>

Environmental Quality, local infrastructures, and residential choice: A survey experiment on ethnic differences in neighborhood preferences (*with Jan Paul Heisig, Tobias Rüttenauer, Merlin Schaeffer, and Jonas Wiedner*)

Ethnic differences in environmental quality and educational outcomes in Italy (*with Risto Conte Keivabu, Fabrizio Bernardi, and Jan Paul Heisig*)

Residential environmental quality and health: Effect heterogeneities by SES and origin?

## **Presentations**

*\* Invited talks*

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|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 05/2025 | ISA Research Committee 28 annual conference, University Pablo de Olavide Seville                                                                    |
| 03/2026 | Annual conference of the German Sociological Association (DGS) Subdivision 'Soziale Ungleichheit und Sozialstrukturanalyse' , University of Potsdam |
| 09/2025 | European Consortium for Sociological Research (ECSR), Annual Conference 2025, Department of Sociology and Social Psychology, University of Cologne  |
| 06/2025 | Mapineq annual meeting, SOFI Stockholm*                                                                                                             |
| 09/2024 | Austrian Economic Association (NOEG) annual conference, BOKU Vienna                                                                                 |
| 05/2024 | ISA Research Committee 28 annual conference, NYU Shanghai                                                                                           |
| 04/2024 | Workshop "Exploring the Role of Geography in Educational Inequality Research", UNED Madrid*                                                         |
| 09/2023 | European Consortium for Sociological Research, Annual Conference 2023, Institute of Sociology at Czech Academy of Sciences                          |
| 09/2022 | Workshop on Environmental Inequality in Europe and Beyond, Technical University of Kaiserslautern                                                   |
| 09/2022 | British Society for Population Studies (BSPS) Conference 2022, University of Winchester                                                             |
| 09/2022 | Projektabschlussstagung "Umweltbelastungen und Umweltressourcen: Soziale Ungleichheiten und gesundheitliche Folgen", University of Göttingen*       |
| 04/2022 | ISA Research Committee 28 annual conference, London School of Economics (LSE)                                                                       |
| 10/2021 | Climate Talk, Center for Sustainability and Society (SUSY), University of Copenhagen*                                                               |
| 10/2021 | European Consortium for Sociological Research (ECSR) Annual Conference (online)                                                                     |
| 09/2021 | Research Seminar, Department of Sociology, University of Copenhagen*                                                                                |
| 06/2021 | ISA Research Committee 28 spring meeting, Turku (online)                                                                                            |
| 03/2021 | Virtual Inequality Brownbag, University of Michigan (online)                                                                                        |
| 02/2021 | Workshop on "Spatial analysis of social, environmental, and health inequalities", WZB Berlin Social Science Center (online)                         |
| 08/2020 | Workshop Environmental Social Sciences, University of Bern (jointly organized with University of Oxford, Nuffield College)                          |
| 06/2020 | EAERE 2020 annual conference, Berlin (online)                                                                                                       |
| 04/2020 | Public Economics Seminar, University of Konstanz*                                                                                                   |

## Teaching

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|------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2025 | Introduction to causal research designs (MA seminar), Free University Berlin     |
| 2024 | Mapping inequalities across the Life Course (MA seminar), Free University Berlin |
| 2022 | Inequality and Social Stratification (MA seminar), Free University Berlin        |

## Media Appearances

(Background) Interview, quoted in "Die Wege des Virus", *Welt am Sonntag*, April 18, 2021.

(Background) Interview, quoted in "Dritte Welle: Besonders viele Migranten auf Intensivstationen?", *Faktenfuchs Bayerischer Rundfunk*, May 5, 2021.

## Languages and Software

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|-----------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Languages | German (native), english (fluent), french (good), spanish (good), Latinum |
| Software  | R, $\LaTeX$ , Markdown, Git, MS Office, Python (basic), Stata (basic)     |

## References

Jan Paul Heisig (WZB Berlin Social Science Center, Freie Universität Berlin)

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Heike Solga (WZB Berlin Social Science Center, Freie Universität Berlin)

Email: [heike.solga@wzb.eu](mailto:heike.solga@wzb.eu)

Rourke O'Brien (Yale University)

Email: [rourke.obrien@yale.edu](mailto:rourke.obrien@yale.edu)

Tobias Rüttenauer (University College London)

Email: [t.ruttenauer@ucl.ac.uk](mailto:t.ruttenauer@ucl.ac.uk)